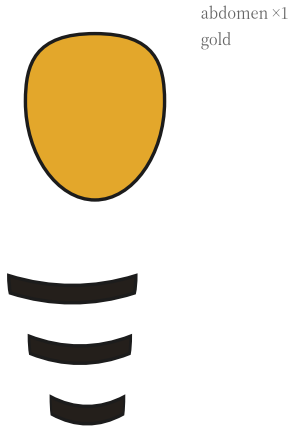


Abdomen & stripes

gold body + black bands · actual size



abdomen ×1
gold

stripes ×3 · black · wide, medium, narrow
— lay these across the gold body.

How to make it

from your felt squares

- 1 Trace each shape onto the right felt colour.
- 2 Cut out all 16 pieces.
- 3 Build it on the mat →

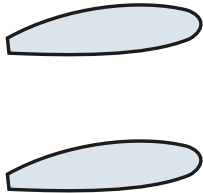
Felt squares you'll use:

- gold — abdomen
- ginger — thorax
- pale grey — wings
- black — stripes, legs & head

Green meadow mat/pouch is premade.

Wings ×2

pale grey · actual size



Two see-through wings that splay out from the thorax. On the finished bee they sit behind the body, one each side.

Build it

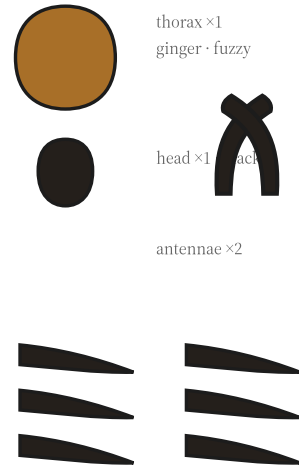
lay the pieces on the mat

- 1 Lay the green mat down — that's the meadow.
- 2 Place the gold abdomen, then the 3 black stripes.
- 3 Add the ginger thorax and black head above.

Nothing is fixed — the pieces just sit like a jigsaw.

Thorax, head & legs

ginger, black · actual size



thorax ×1
ginger · fuzzy

head ×1 · black

antennae ×2

legs ×6 · black · three each side

...and again

it's a puzzle, not a glue-up

- 4 Slot a wing out each side behind the thorax.
- 5 Tuck the 6 legs under — three each side.
- 6 Add the two antennae, then take it apart and rebuild!

Angle the wings a little each time — no two builds are alike.

Finished!

the same pieces, assembled



gold striped body · ginger thorax · pale wings

At a glance

16 felt pieces

- 1 abdomen (gold)
- 3 stripes (black)
- 1 thorax (ginger)
- 1 head (black)
- 2 wings (grey)
- 6 legs (black)
- 2 antennae (black)

Finished size

≈ 6 × 4 cm (wings out)

Theme: Meadow. Collect the ladybird and butterfly too.

The real thing



Apis mellifera — the honey bee. The worker is Manchester's emblem, the busy city bee.

Photo © Charlie Farrell, CC0, via iNaturalist. River Irk, Rhodes — about 7 km from Manchester.

Did you know?

- Manchester's worker bee stands for the city's hard graft.
- Spot it on bins, bollards and the Town Hall mosaic floor.
- Every worker bee is female — she does all the hive's jobs.
- She visits about 1,500 flowers a day to gather nectar.
- Bees "talk" by dancing to point the way to food.

FuzzleWorld

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Collect the set

Meadow · Aquatic · Underground

Manchester bee · ladybird · butterfly dragonfly · maybug · more...


Make your own
Manchester Bee
Instructions

A Giant Insect World felt puzzle
build it · take it apart · build it again



Species: A. mellifera · Photo © Charlie Farrell, CC0 · Logo © Giant Insect World